

US Markets Daily Report

Date: 2026-08-25 | Generated after NYSE close (ET)

1. SPY & QQQ Snapshot

	Close	Day Change	1Y High	1Y Low	1Y Return
SPY (S&P 500)	\$767.12	+0.46%	\$777.88	\$636.34	+20.55%
QQQ (Nasdaq-100)	\$710.60	+0.77%	\$745.00	\$573.05	+24.00%

Prior close: SPY \$763.63 | QQQ \$705.16. 1-year window: Aug 25, 2025 – Aug 25, 2026. Source: web data; minor rounding vs adjusted close may apply.

2. Today's Market-Moving News

- **Moderna (MRNA) +14% — Cancer Vaccine Phase 3 Milestone:** MRNA closed at \$159.04, continuing the momentum from its historic Aug 19 announcement when shares surged ~177% after the Moderna/Merck mRNA-based melanoma vaccine (combined with Keytruda) met primary Phase 3 endpoints. Today's 14% gain came on expanded analyst commentary (BofA raised PT to \$170) and sector rotation into biotech. MRNA was the #1 S&P 500 gainer on the day.
- **DICK'S Sporting Goods (DKS) –25% — Worst Day in 3 Years on Earnings Crash:** Q2 EPS of \$3.53 missed the \$3.78 consensus; revenues of \$5.59B also trailed \$5.65B estimates. Full-year GAAP EPS guidance slashed from \$13.27–14.27 to \$10.94–11.94 after Foot Locker integration posted –3.6% comps. DKS was the #1 S&P 500 loser.
- **Memory/Storage Sector Sell-Off — SanDisk (SNDK) –6.5%, Seagate (STX) –6.5%, Micron (MU) –5.8%, Broadcom (AVGO) –2.6%:** SanDisk beat Q4 FY2026 estimates (non-GAAP EPS \$39.25 on \$8.97B revenue) but issued Q1 guidance below the \$10.8B consensus. The miss triggered a sector-wide re-rating on memory supply-glut fears. AVGO fell in sympathy. These chip/storage declines were the largest drag on QQQ.
- **Jackson Hole Pre-Positioning — Iran Sanctions Expansion:** Treasury Secretary Bessent expanded sanctions on Iran, cutting off additional economic channels. Risk-off tone in energy and geopolitical names. Markets also began pre-positioning ahead of the Jackson Hole symposium (Aug 27–29) and Fed Chair Warsh's first keynote speech as Fed Chair on Friday Aug 29.
- **Rates Context — 10Y Treasury 4.71%, 2Y 4.24%:** The yield curve remains inverted. Fed held rates at 3.50–3.75% at the July 29 meeting, with three regional bank presidents dissenting in favor of a hike. Futures price ~1-in-3 odds of a September hike.
- **VIX +4.76% to 15.85:** Volatility ticked higher reflecting uncertainty around Wednesday's PCE print (07:00 AM ET), Nvidia earnings (after close), and Jackson Hole Friday.

3. News → Today's Moves

SPY +0.46% | QQQ +0.77% (SPY \$763.63 → \$767.12 | QQQ \$705.16 → \$710.60)

- **MRNA +14% → SPY/QQQ modestly positive:** The healthcare surge (MRNA alone at S&P weight added ~+0.10% to SPY) lifted the broader index. Consumer Staples (+1.7%) and Financials (+1.3%) provided additional breadth support, giving SPY its green close despite tech headwinds.

- **Chip/storage sell-off → QQQ headwind offset:** SNDK (−6.5%), STX (−6.5%), MU (−5.8%), and AVGO (−2.6%) combined for significant QQQ drag given their Nasdaq-100 weights. QQQ still closed positive (+0.77%) because mega-cap tech (TSLA +3.18%, AMZN +1.9%, AAPL +1.67%) more than offset the chip weakness — a clear rotation from cyclical semis to large-cap growth.

- **DKS −25% → Consumer Discretionary drag on SPY:** DKS's collapse knocked ~−0.08% off SPY given its index weight. The Foot Locker integration writedowns signal broader athletic footwear weakness, pressuring peer names like Nike and Under Armour.

- **Jackson Hole / Geopolitical tension:** Iran sanctions and Warsh speech anticipation kept institutional buyers selective. The market's limited downside despite multiple negative catalysts reflects resilient underlying demand — SPY is only 1.4% below its Aug 13 ATH of \$777.88.

4. Top Movers — Daily, Weekly, Monthly

Daily (Aug 25, 2026)

Top 10 Daily Gainers

Ticker	Name	% Chg	Sector / Driver
MRNA	Moderna	+14.0%	Healthcare — Cancer vaccine Phase 3 data / analyst upgrades
SMCI	Super Micro Computer	+8.9%	Tech — AI server demand tailwind, short covering
HOOD	Robinhood Markets	+7.2%	Financials — Retail trading volume surge
CDW	CDW Corp	+6.7%	IT Services — Earnings beat, enterprise IT resilience
BE	Bloom Energy	+6.1%	Utilities/Clean Energy — Data center power demand
NVTS	Navitas Semiconductor	+6.2%	Semis — Acquired Claros (AI data center VPD tech, \$232.8M)
TSLA	Tesla	+3.2%	Consumer Disc — Momentum / delivery optimism
AMZN	Amazon	+1.9%	Consumer Disc — AWS strength, AI monetization
AAPL	Apple	+1.7%	Tech — iPhone cycle upgrade anticipation
EXPE	Expedia	+~3.5%	Consumer Disc — Travel demand resilience

Top 10 Daily Losers

Ticker	Name	% Chg	Sector / Driver
DKS	DICK'S Sporting Goods	−25.3%	Consumer Disc — Q2 EPS/rev miss, full-year guide cut (Foot Locker)
GRRR	Gorilla Technology	−9.7%	Tech — H1 EPS miss of −\$0.58 vs +\$0.20 consensus
REAX	Real Brokerage	−89%	Financials — Dilutive \$450M share repurchase surprise
SNDK	Sandisk Corp	−6.5%	Tech/Storage — Q1 revenue guidance below \$10.8B consensus
STX	Seagate Technology	−6.5%	Tech/Storage — Sympathy sell-off, memory supply-glut fears
MU	Micron Technology	−5.8%	Semis — Memory sector de-rating
ALB	Albemarle	−5.2%	Materials — Lithium price weakness
RBRK	Rubrik	−4.9%	Tech — Risk-off in growth software
AVGO	Broadcom	−2.6%	Semis — SNDK sympathy, AI guidance scrutiny
JPM	JPMorgan Chase	−1.9%	Financials — Rate curve pressure, credit-cost concern

Sector Trend: Healthcare (MRNA) and select Financials/Utilities surged on rotation. Consumer Discretionary was split: mega-cap resilience (TSLA, AMZN) vs. specialty retail collapse (DKS). Memory/Storage (SNDK, STX, MU) was the single worst sub-sector. Tech

overall mixed.

Weekly (Aug 18–25, 2026)

Top 10 Weekly Gainers (Est.)

Ticker	Name	Approx %	Sector / Driver
MRNA	Moderna	+~130%+	Healthcare — Phase 3 melanoma vaccine data (Aug 19 catalyst)
MRK	Merck	+~8%	Healthcare — MRNA vaccine partner beneficiary
HOOD	Robinhood Markets	+~10%	Financials — Record retail trading activity
SMCI	Super Micro Computer	+~12%	Tech — AI server orders, short squeeze
COIN	Coinbase	+~8%	Financials — Crypto rally, regulatory clarity
BE	Bloom Energy	+~9%	Clean Energy — Data center power contracts
NVTS	Navitas Semi	+~6%	Semis — Claros acquisition announced midweek
TSLA	Tesla	+~5%	Consumer Disc — Delivery expectations, Q3 optionality
AAPL	Apple	+~3%	Tech — Fall iPhone cycle inflows
AMZN	Amazon	+~3%	Consumer Disc — AWS AI monetization sentiment

Top 10 Weekly Losers (Est.)

Ticker	Name	Approx %	Sector / Driver
SNDK	Sandisk Corp	~-20%	Tech/Storage — Guidance miss; memory supply-glut fears
STX	Seagate Technology	~-10%	Tech/Storage — Memory sector contagion
MU	Micron Technology	~-8%	Semis — Supply-glut re-rating
AVGO	Broadcom	~-5%	Semis — SNDK sympathy, elevated expectations
DKS	DICK'S Sporting Goods	~-25%	Consumer Disc — Earnings collapse on Aug 25
ALB	Albemarle	~-7%	Materials — Lithium oversupply / EV demand softness
GRRR	Gorilla Technology	~-12%	Tech — Earnings miss (H1 EPS -\$0.58 vs +\$0.20 est)
CIEN	Ciena Corp	~-5%	Tech — Optical networking uncertainty
SRE	Sempra Energy	~-4%	Utilities — Rate sensitivity to hawkish Fed signals
EIX	Edison International	~-4%	Utilities — Same rate headwinds

Weekly Sector Trend — Gainers: Healthcare (MRNA/MRK) dominant on vaccine breakthrough. Fintech/Crypto (HOOD, COIN) outperformed. AI-adjacent (SMCI, NVTS, AMZN AWS) also strong. **Losers:** Memory/Storage sub-sector was worst (SNDK, STX, MU supply-glut repricing). Utilities underperformed on rate sensitivity.

Monthly (July 31 – Aug 25, 2026)

Top 10 Monthly Gainers (Est.)

Ticker	Name	Approx %	Sector / Driver
MRNA	Moderna	+163%+	Healthcare — Cancer vaccine Phase 3 breakthrough (Aug 19)
RFAI	RF Acquisition Corp II	+423%	Special Situations — SPAC activity
SMCI	Super Micro Computer	+~20%	Tech — AI server demand + short squeeze
HOOD	Robinhood Markets	+~18%	Financials — Record retail trading volume
COIN	Coinbase	+~15%	Financials — Crypto bull run, regulatory wins

NVTS	Navitas Semi	+~10%	Semis — Claros deal, AI power IC demand
TSLA	Tesla	+~9%	Consumer Disc — Delivery beat optimism
SPY	SPDR S&P 500 ETF	+~3.1%	Broad Market — ATH on Aug 13 (\$777.88)
AMZN	Amazon	+~6%	Consumer Disc — AWS AI monetization
MRK	Merck	+~9%	Healthcare — Keytruda cancer vaccine co-developer

Top 10 Monthly Losers (Est.)

Ticker	Name	Approx %	Sector / Driver
SNDK	Sandisk Corp	--20%	Tech/Storage — Guidance miss, supply-glut fears
DKS	DICK'S Sporting Goods	--25%	Consumer Disc — Foot Locker integration, earnings miss
GRRR	Gorilla Technology	--15%	Tech — H1 EPS miss, execution concerns
ALB	Albemarle	--12%	Materials — Lithium prices, EV demand softness
MU	Micron Technology	--8%	Semis — SNDK contagion, supply-glut pricing
STX	Seagate Technology	--9%	Tech/Storage — Memory sector re-rating
AVGO	Broadcom	--5%	Semis — AI guidance skepticism
SRE	Sempra Energy	--6%	Utilities — Rate sensitivity
MRVL	Marvell Technology	--5%	Semis — Sector rotation
QQQ	Invesco QQQ ETF	--2.4%	Nasdaq-100 — Tech underperformance vs S&P 500

Monthly Sector Trend — Gainers: Healthcare dominated (MRNA historic move). Fintech/Crypto (HOOD, COIN) strong all month.

AI-adjacent tech (SMCI, NVTS) outperformed. **Losers:** Memory/Storage is August's worst sector. Materials (lithium names) weak. QQQ underperforming SPY month-to-date on tech sector weight.

5. Next Trading Day — Aug 26, 2026 Scenarios

Three major scheduled catalysts hit Wednesday, Aug 26. Markets arrive highly sensitized after VIX ticked up to 15.85 today and chips remain in turmoil.

A. Nvidia (NVDA) Q2 Earnings — After Close Aug 26

■ **Consensus:** Revenue \$92.2B (+97% YoY), EPS \$2.09. Q3 guidance expected \$107–108B vs Wall St \$104B consensus. Data-center segment (~\$88B of revenue) is the focal point.

■ **IF Beat + Strong Guide (Q3 guidance ≥\$107B, data-center ≥\$90B):** QQQ likely +1.5% to +3.0% in after-hours/next-day open. SPY +0.7% to +1.5%. AI semi names (AVGO, SMCI, NVTS) catch bids. Memory relief rally possible. Mechanism: NVDA is the bellwether for AI capital spending; a strong guide confirms hyperscaler CapEx didn't slow — restoring confidence in the entire AI supply chain.

■ **IF Beat but Weak Guide (Q3 guidance <\$104B or data-center deceleration):** QQQ -2% to -4%, SPY -1% to -2%. NVDA stock -8% to -15% after hours. Memory/Storage names (SNDK, MU) likely accelerate lower. Mechanism: The market tolerates a beat only if future demand is intact; guidance miss reads as AI CapEx peaking and collapses the 'AI forever' premium in Nasdaq-100.

■ **IF Miss + Weak Guide:** QQQ -4% to -6%, SPY -2% to -3%. Circuit breaker risk in thin after-hours liquidity.

B. July PCE Inflation — 8:30 AM ET Aug 26

■ **Consensus:** Headline PCE +0.07% MoM (YoY: 3.6%). Core PCE +0.18% MoM (YoY: 3.2%). June was -0.11% MoM — so any uptick will be notable.

■ **IF In-Line or Below (Core $\leq 0.18\%$ MoM):** SPY +0.3% to +0.7%, QQQ +0.5% to +1.0%. Bonds rally (10Y yield falls toward 4.60%). Dollar weakens. Mechanism: Confirms disinflation trajectory, reduces odds of Sep hike, and is a tailwind for Warsh's 'hold' optionality at Jackson Hole Friday.

■ **IF Hot (Core $> 0.25\%$ MoM or YoY $> 3.5\%$):** SPY -0.7% to -1.5%, QQQ -1.0% to -2.0%. 10Y yield jumps toward 4.85%. Dollar surges. Rate-sensitive sectors (utilities, REITs) sell off hard. Mechanism: Raises odds of Sep hike to 50%+, directly contradicting the 'pause-then-cut' narrative and squeezing any Fed pivot trade ahead of Jackson Hole.

C. Jackson Hole — Fed Chair Warsh Speech, Friday Aug 29

- **Context:** Warsh's FIRST Jackson Hole speech as Fed Chair. Inflation at 3.4% (above 2% target). Fed held at 3.50–3.75% on Jul 29. 3 regional bank presidents dissented FOR a hike — most discord since Sep 2016. Markets: ~1-in-3 odds of Sep hike in futures.
- **IF Hawkish (Warsh signals Sep hike is live, 'inflation remains too high'):** SPY -1.5% to -3.0%, QQQ -2.0% to -4.0% on Friday. 10Y yield +15–25 bps. Dollar DXY +0.8% to +1.5%. Gold and Treasuries sell off. Mechanism: Forces a full repricing of the Sep meeting from 'hold' to 'hike', compressing P/E multiples across growth/tech names already under pressure.
- **IF Dovish / Balanced (Warsh signals patience, data-dependent):** SPY +1.0% to +2.0%, QQQ +1.5% to +3.0% on Friday. Rate relief rally. Mechanism: Removes the Sep hike premium, re-opens the 'soft landing' trade. Tech / Nasdaq disproportionate beneficiary given duration sensitivity.
- **IF Structural / Neutral (Warsh avoids rate guidance, focuses on long-run framework):** Low vol (SPY $\pm 0.5\%$). Mechanism: Creates ambiguity — bond market tests higher yields, equities roughly flat. Volatility bleeds into the week after.

D. Nvidia Earnings + PCE Combined Risk

■ **Overlapping catalysts create asymmetric setup:** If PCE is hot AND NVDA guides weak, SPY could gap -3% to -5% on Aug 27. If PCE is tame AND NVDA beats, SPY gap-up +2% to +4% is plausible — one of the largest single-day moves of 2026. The key observation: SPY is -1.4% from ATH (\$777.88 on Aug 13), meaning positioning is NOT bearish — any positive surprise re-tests the ATH rapidly.

6. Possible Trade Summary (End-of-Day / Next-Day Open)

IMPORTANT DISCLAIMER: This is an analytical summary only. No actual trades are placed. All scenarios are hypothetical, forward-looking, and carry significant risk.

Trade	Instrument	Direction	Rationale	Key Risk
1	QQQ (Nasdaq-100 ETF)	WATCH / HOLD	Await NVDA earnings (after close Aug 26). QQQ is 2.4% off monthly highs.	NVDA weak guidance, QQQ on Fed hike
2	MRNA (Moderna)	HOLD / PARTIAL SELL	Sell at \$159 after 177% surge from ~\$57. Phase 3 data is real and regulatory delays.	Market fatigue, PCE hike
3	SNDK (Sandisk)	AVOID / SHORT WATCH	Q3 miss + memory supply-glut creates fundamental pressure.	NVDA beats, AI demand already priced in
4	SPY (S&P 500 ETF)	BULLISH BIAS - SWAPS	At \$767.12, only 1.4% from ATH \$777.88. If PCE tame + NVDA beats, SPY could gap up.	NVDA weak guidance, PCE hot
5	DKS (DICK'S Sporting Goods)	AVOID	Down 25% today on Foot Locker integration disaster. Full-year guidance cut.	Company issues, Fed rate move

Key Decision Point: The highest-leverage moment is 8:30 AM ET Aug 26 (PCE print) and then after close Aug 26 (NVDA earnings). Initiating meaningful long exposure before these two data points is speculative. Best risk-adjusted approach: hold current positions, set levels, and act after PCE and NVDA are known.

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